

Simon Wardan

Principal Engineer · Technical Leader

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SUMMARY

Principal engineer and technical leader with 12+ years advising enterprise clients, working where the commercial and technical conversations meet. I've been **pivotal in winning seven-figure engagements** with Qantas, Jetstar and the ATO, then owned their delivery, scope and budget. Since Google's early DialogFlow (2017) I've put **applied AI into production** across healthcare and insurance, and architect **cloud-native systems sustaining thousands of requests per second**. Alongside that: **10+ engineers mentored** into senior and lead roles, hiring and interviewing, and national speaking at Atlassian, Amazon and Google.

LEADERSHIP & CLIENT ADVISORY

- **Pre-sales & solution scoping** — Technical proposals, estimates and SOWs across dozens of enterprise pursuits; **pivotal in winning seven-figure engagements** at Qantas, Jetstar and the ATO
- **Winning the room** — Presented the solution to **20+ federal government stakeholders** for the ATO's digital services API gateway, pushing back on requirements that weren't technically feasible and reshaping scope to what would actually work
- **Delivery ownership** — Tech lead and delivery manager on almost every engagement, accountable for **scope, budget and client outcome**, not just the architecture
- **Mentoring & growth** — Career mentor to **10+ engineers**, several of whom progressed into senior engineer and technical lead roles
- **Hiring** — Major contributor to hiring and interviewing, helping set and hold the technical bar
- **Facilitation & influence** — Ran discovery workshops and architecture reviews that shaped client technology direction: **buy-vs-build, platform consolidation, legacy modernisation** and product strategy
- **Public speaking** — **National tech talks** at Atlassian, Amazon, Google and Web Directions to audiences of several hundred

CORE EXPERTISE

Solution Architecture

Pre-Sales & Scoping

Enterprise AI/ML

Cloud-Native (AWS)

Technical Leadership

Stakeholder Management

Delivery & Budget
Ownership

Technical Consulting

Application Security

Rapid Prototyping

Performance & Load
Testing

Agile / Scrum

Lead Consultant → Principal Architect → Principal Engineer, **Terem Technologies**

Oct 2013 — Present

Qantas

Jetstar

Bupa

QBE

Chemist Warehouse

TfNSW

ATO

- Served as **primary technical advisor** to product owners, heads of engineering and CTOs, delivering **dozens of projects** across aviation, insurance, healthcare, government and retail
- Architected **cloud-native systems sustaining thousands of requests per second** — flight-operations software streamlining **80%+ of the national carrier's flights**
- Built **AI products for healthcare and insurance** that saved **thousands of hours** of manual review, pre-filling and summarising content for expert review and sign-off
- Shaped and delivered the solution for the ATO's digital services API gateway, integrating **Google Apigee** into federal government systems
- Led hackathon teams to multiple wins — including **top prize at the 2018 AUSTRAC ASEAN codeathon**, presented by the Minister for Law Enforcement & Cyber Security
- Shipped two products featured on national **TV and newspaper front pages**, and empowered a broadcaster to publish clips within seconds of live broadcast (previously days)

CTO & Board Member, **Floktu**

May 2011 — Oct 2013

Rugby Union

Fairfax

- As a board member, **led the pivot** off a failing rapid-app-generation model onto a **true SaaS model** — event content + ticketing — which went on to process **tens of millions of dollars** across **thousands of events**
- **Recruited and led a team of 5**; ran **fundraising, investor briefings and board reporting** alongside the technical strategy
- Led sales meetings and client workshops; won and ran all corporate hospitality ticketing for the **Australian Rugby Union** and booth sales for Good Food Month
- Engineered a plugin system that let the team deliver bespoke client functionality without forking the platform

LEADERSHIP & ADVISORY

Client Advisory

Proposals & SOWs

Delivery Management

Team Leadership

Hiring & Interviewing

Mentoring & Coaching

Workshop Facilitation

Public Speaking

Board & Investor Relations

LANGUAGES

Python

TypeScript

JavaScript

Swift

C#

Ruby

PLATFORMS

AWS

GCP

Google Apigee

Azure

AI Vision

Generative AI

AI Tooling

Conversational AI

iOS & Android

REST APIs

WebSockets

Team Leader, **Made In Katana**

Jan 2008 — May 2011

Chugg Entertainment

ARIA Awards

Short Stack

Silverchair

Kylie Minogue

- Technical lead for a **team of up to 10**; authored an industry-tailored app framework and shipped **~two dozen apps** on it over three years
- Built **Pharmacy4u**, a "Shopify for pharmacies" platform that brought **hundreds of pharmacies** and dozens of brands online
- Shipped **App Store–featured** apps and sites for major music artists (Chugg Entertainment, Kylie Minogue, Silverchair, Short Stack), driving exposure and downloads for label-promoted releases
- Grew the Short Stack fan app into a large community — the band ran in-app competitions, naming winners and giving out prizes through it

INDUSTRIES

Healthcare · Transport ·
Entertainment · E-
commerce · Government

Project Manager, **Bywave**

Jun 2006 — Dec 2007

- Managed projects and client relationships alongside development responsibilities
- Built e-commerce sites for small and medium businesses; configured and deployed web hosting and handled ongoing support

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computer Science, **Computer Forensics** **Major**

University of Western Sydney

PERSONAL PROJECTS

BJJCal

ICS calendar feeds of Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu competitions for every country, refreshed daily.

Glitched

A browser-playable game built in Godot (GDScript).

gh-clean

A `gh` CLI extension that clears out done and stale local git branches.

BJJ Timer

A focused, no-nonsense round timer for Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu training.

Glyph

An emoji-only social platform — posts are pure emoji, each with a unique three-word URL.

Logo Detector

Computer-vision tool that scans video for brand logos using OpenCV and FFmpeg.

Chatrio

Zero-configuration video chat over the web, using web sockets for fast video sessions.

GMT

Community-driven site that ran for ~8 years. My first serious foray into software, and where I found my passion for it.

Ebookers Explorer

Social-media aggregation backend for an iPad app — aggregating, parsing and serving data via JSON.